

SWISS CHARD *Beta vulgaris* subsp. *cicla* var. *flavescens*

Swiss chard and spinach beet are often referred to as “leaf beets,” since both are related to the beet, but, conversely, they produce large, delicious leaves and insignificant, inedible roots. Swiss chard is an attractive plant often grown as an ornamental plant, since its leaves have veins and stems in a range of colors, from vivid red and yellow to purple. Swiss chard has a peppery flavor and is cooked and eaten like spinach.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Swiss chard likes a fertile, moisture-retentive soil, so dig in some well-rotted manure or compost in the fall before sowing, or add a balanced fertilizer to the soil. If the pH of the soil is below 6.5, consider adding some lime to the soil, since Swiss chard likes alkaline conditions. Provide crops with a sunny, sheltered position.

Seed can be sown directly into the soil or grown in modules in a greenhouse or cold frame and then transplanted when established. Sow at a depth of 1 in (2.5 cm) and space rows 18 in (45 cm) apart. Once seedlings are established, thin out, depending on your requirements; if growing for



Leave cut stems in the ground to resprout.

salad crops, leave 4 in (10 cm) between plants; larger plants will need more space, so give them 12 in (30 cm) between plants.

CROP CARE

Keep chard well-watered and free from weeds. Remove any flowering buds to encourage the plant to direct its energy into its leaves. If you are leaving plants in the ground to overwinter,